

Rule 100001- Multiple Failed SSH Logins

A user attempted to log in via SSH with an incorrect password, Wazuh's base rule 5716 detected repeated authentication failures from the same source.

This is important because repeated failed logins are the classic signature of a brute-force attack, where an attacker or automated tool tries many password combinations against a valid or guessed username. Left unnoticed, this can eventually lead to a successful compromise if a weak password exists.

A SOC analyst would check the source IP against threat intelligence feeds, confirm whether the targeted account is legitimate, consider blocking the source IP, and verify no successful login followed the failed attempts.

Rule 100002- New User Account Created

A new local user account was created on the system, which Wazuh detected through its default account management rule set.

This is important because unauthorized account creation is a common persistence technique. Attackers who gain initial access often create a new account to maintain access even if the original compromised credentials are revoked or discovered.

A SOC analyst would verify the account creation was performed by an authorized administrator, check the account's assigned privileges, and investigate the parent process or session that issued the command.

Rule 100003- Password Change Command Executed

A user executed the `passwd` command via `sudo` to change a system account's password. Wazuh detected this by matching the text 'passwd' within a `sudo` command log entry, which fires whenever a `sudo` session is opened and logged in `auth.log`.

This is important because password changes are a normal administrative action, but they are also a step attackers take after compromising an account, either to lock out the legitimate owner or to secure their own persistence with a password they control. Tracking every password change gives visibility into who is changing credentials and when.

A SOC analyst would confirm the password change was requested or performed by the account owner or an authorized administrator, check whether it followed any suspicious login activity, and verify no other account changes occurred around the same time.

Rule 100004- Failed Attempt to Switch User (su)

A user attempted to switch to another account (typically root) using the su command but entered an incorrect password which triggered the alert.

This is important because failed su attempts can indicate an attacker, or an unauthorized user, trying to escalate from a limited account to root access, especially if it happens repeatedly or from an unexpected session, su failures suggest someone already has some level of access to the system and is attempting to gain full administrative control it could be an insider threat or a more advanced stage of a potential compromise.

A SOC analyst would identify which local user account attempted the su command and cross reference it against expected admin behavior. Repeated failures from the same account in a short window would warrant immediate investigation, including checking what that user did immediately before and after the attempt, and whether their original login was itself suspicious.

Rule 100005- Sudo Session Opened by User

A user successfully executed a command with sudo, opening a privileged session, which Wazuh detected via PAM session logs.

This is important because while sudo usage is often legitimate, tracking every privileged session gives visibility into who is executing administrative commands and when, which is critical for spotting misuse of compromised credentials or insider threats attempting unauthorized privileged actions.

A SOC analyst would cross reference the user and timestamp against expected admin activity, check what commands were run during the session, and flag any sudo usage outside normal working hours or from unusual source IPs as higher priority.